

your bag like a bulky sweater might. Besides, if you really want one of those, you can buy one made from a local artisan on the trip. It makes a functional souvenir and you'll be helping out the local economy. We picked up a couple in Peru and shipped them home during the trip once we switched climates.

5. Consider minimalism

I'm not saying to deprive yourself to the level where you won't have a good time, but it is possible to pack everything you need and still save on space and number of items. Bring multiuse items, even if they're not your favorites. For example, I prefer liquid foundation, but the pressed powder is more compact, lighter, and there's no risk of leaks. Bring solid shampoo and conditioning bars rather than big bottles, and choose alternative reusable feminine products.

6. Pick a color scheme

Selecting items of clothing that have the most versatility for maximum mix and match opportunities is crucial. A color scheme will ensure that any top can go with any bottom you brought.

7. Wear as much as possible on travel day

Think leggings under travel pants, tank top or swimsuit under a dress, T-shirt under longer-sleeved shirt, etc. It's usually chilly on the plane, so an extra layer or two won't be super uncomfortable. Clothing with large and/or many pockets can be useful when trying to avoid needing an extra piece of luggage.

8. Quick-dry is king

This also fits in with the thinner is better philosophy listed above. The quicker items dry after sink or shower washing, the sooner you'll be able to wear them again or pack them and hit the road without risking that mildew smell that's hard to get rid of.

9. Multipurpose

There are men's swim trunks that are lined and look more like travel shorts. Women's swimsuits make a great underwear substitute, and bandanas, in addition to having multiple uses around the house, are a great travel item.

10. Digitize, digitize, digitize

Take photos of your travel documents and send them to yourself via email. If